with the level at which they are playing now. They've had some domestic success and, in a couple of cases, have had a taste of international cricket, and that seems to be enough for them.

Stuff like the sponsored car, the fancy sunglasses and the latest kit – all the peripheries – seem more important to them than working hard to improve their game every season. I keep on telling them that nowadays there's just so much more opportunity to make real money, especially with 20/20 cricket.

For that to happen, though, these guys have to up their game on the international stage. And for that to happen, they have to make the final of our domestic Standard Bank Pro20 competition and then do well at the new T20 Champions League tournament against the world's other top franchises. Either that, or cement a permanent place in the national side, where one of the IPL or English county teams can notice you. Then you start making the cash. Unfortunately, we have a few lazy and overweight cricketers in South Africa.

Throughout my career it's been said that I am a naturally gifted cricketer, and that *is* true – I have been blessed. But I've also had to work hard at technical elements of my game. Sure, my natural abilities are a huge bonus, but these can't always carry me through. As I've said in Chapter 1, when I first started playing provincial cricket, I struggled a little when I started out – well, quite a lot, actually.

And for two or three years into my international career I also struggled with my batting form. My teammate, Brian McMillan, gave me some invaluable advice which I have stuck with to this day. 'Listen,' he said (you always listened when Mackie said 'listen'), 'when you line yourself up in your crease, make sure that your head is pointing over off-stump. And use that as a set-up and as a guideline, whether you're in a slump or playing well.'

It's all I've ever done since, and out there in the middle I probably focus more on following Mackie's advice than on the ball. Especially when I am up against express pace, I concentrate on keeping my head still instead of watching the ball. That might seem weird, but it works for me. Obviously I *do* watch the ball – that's instinct. You can pick up in the replays that my eyes are focused on the ball, otherwise I'd never make contact with it, but my basic guide is to keep my head still for as long as possible. If I don't, I often go out lbw when the ball nips back. My head has moved, I've planted